

Song Map Planner

How long will my song be?

Seconds = bars × 4 × 60 ÷ BPM

Example: 40 bars at 100 BPM → $40 \times 4 \times 60 \div 100 = 96$ seconds (1:36).

Song 1 map (First Song form)

Title: _____ **Key:** _____ **Tempo:** _____ BPM

1. **Intro** — 4 bars — What plays: _____ Energy (1–5): ____
2. **Verse 1** — 8 bars — What plays: _____ Energy: ____
3. **Chorus** — 8 bars — What plays: _____ Energy: ____
4. **Verse 2** — 8 bars — What plays: _____ Energy: ____
5. **Chorus** — 8 bars — What plays: _____ Energy: ____
6. **Outro** — 4 bars — What plays: _____ Energy: ____

Total bars: _____ **Length:** _____

Song 2 map (Full Pop form)

Title: _____ **Key:** _____ **Tempo:** _____ BPM

1. **Intro** — 4 bars — _____ Energy: ____
2. **Verse 1** — 8 bars — _____ Energy: ____
3. **Pre-chorus** — 4 bars — _____ Energy: ____
4. **Chorus** — 8 bars — _____ Energy: ____
5. **Verse 2** — 8 bars — _____ Energy: ____
6. **Pre-chorus** — 4 bars — _____ Energy: ____
7. **Chorus** — 8 bars — _____ Energy: ____
8. **Bridge** — 8 bars — _____ Energy: ____
9. **Final Chorus** — 8–16 bars — _____ Energy: ____

10. **Outro** — 4 bars — _____ Energy: ____

Lift for the final chorus: key change / new layer / drop and return / ad-libs

Energy curve

Draw a line across this page from left to right. Up = bigger, down = smaller.

A typical pop curve:

- Intro: low
 - Verse 1: medium
 - Chorus: high
 - Verse 2: medium, a bit higher than verse 1
 - Chorus: high
 - Bridge: drop down *or* build up
 - Final chorus: **highest**
 - Outro: low
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Ways to raise energy

- Add an instrument
- Drums get busier (more hi-hat, more kick)
- Melody goes higher
- Add a harmony or double the vocal
- A fill or riser right before the section

Ways to lower energy

- Mute instruments (the mute button is your best tool)
- Simpler drums, or no drums
- Lower melody, fewer words
- Chords held longer